Informatica®

Informatica® Cloud Data Integration

Flat File Connector

Informatica Cloud Data Integration Flat File Connector
October 2025

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Preface

Use *Flat File Connections* to learn how to configure delimited and fixed-width flat file connections and for information about flat file connection properties.

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CHAPTER 1

Flat file connections

Flat file connections enable you to create, access, and store flat files. You can use flat file connections in mappings and in tasks such as mapping tasks, PowerCenter tasks, replication tasks, and synchronization tasks.

When you configure a flat file connection, you must select the runtime environment to be used with the connection. If you select a runtime environment with Secure Agents that run on Linux, you cannot specify a Windows directory for a flat file target.

A flat file connection cannot use a Secure Agent that runs on NTT. Therefore, do not select a runtime environment with Secure Agents that run on NTT.

In a serverless runtime environment that has data disks configured, you can choose one of the mounted directories or their sub directories to use in the flat file connection.

When you select a flat file connection in a mapping or task, you choose the formatting options for the flat file. When you choose the formatting options in a Source, Lookup, or Target transformation, you specify whether the flat file is a delimited flat file or a fixed-width flat file. If the flat file is a fixed-width flat file, you select a fixed-width format from a list of fixed-width formats that you configured. If you plan to use a fixed-width flat file, you need to create at least one fixed-width format before you select a fixed-width flat file in the Mapping Designer.

Flat file connection properties

Defines the properties you need to assign to for a flat file source connection.

The following table describes the flat file connection properties:

Connection Property	Description
Connection Name	A name for the connection. This name must be unique within the organization. Connection names can contain alphanumeric characters, spaces, and the following special characters: _ . + - Spaces at the beginning or end of the name are trimmed and are not saved as part of the name. Maximum length is 100 characters. Connection names are not case sensitive.
Description	An optional description for the connection. Maximum length is 255 characters.

Connection Property	Description
Use Secret Vault	Stores sensitive credentials for this connection in the secrets manager that is configured for your organization. This property appears only if secrets manager is set up for your organization. When you enable the secret vault in the connection, you can select which credentials that the Secure Agent retrieves from the secrets manager. If you don't enable this option, the credentials are stored in the repository or on a local Secure Agent, depending on how your organization is configured. **Note:** If you're using this connection to apply data access policies through pushdown or proxy services, you cannot use the Secret Vault configuration option. For information about how to configure and use a secrets manager, see "Secrets manager configuration" in the Administrator help.
Runtime Environment	Runtime environment that contains the Secure Agent to use for accessing the flat files. Select a Secure Agent, serverless, or elastic runtime environment. Ensure the serverless runtime environment contains the mounted EFS or NFS directories which contain the flat files. For database ingestion and replication tasks, select a Secure Agent. You can't use a Hosted Agent, serverless runtime environment, or elastic runtime environment. **Note:** Do not select a runtime environment with Secure Agents that run on NTT. A flat file connection cannot use a Secure Agent that runs on NTT.

Directory	Directory accessible by all Secure Agents in the selected runtime environment where the flat file is stored.
	Enter the full directory or click **Browse** to locate and select the directory.
	When you use the connection, you can select a file that's contained in the directory or in any of its subdirectories.
	This directory is also used in any data disks configured for a serverless runtime environment.
	Maximum length is 100 characters. Directory names can contain alphanumeric characters, spaces, and the following special characters:
	`/ \ : _ ~`
	The directory is the service URL for this connection type.
	Note: On Windows, the **Browse for Directory** dialog box doesn't display mapped drives. You can browse My Network Places in Windows Explorer to locate the directory and copy the location from the address bar or enter the directory name in the following format: `\\<server_name>\<directory_path>`. If network directories do not display, you can configure a login for the Secure Agent service. This functionality might not be available on newer versions of Windows.
	Do not include the name of the flat file. You specify the file name when you create the task.
	In a serverless runtime environment, this directory must be one of the mounted directories or their subdirectories in the data disk.
	When you process data in a flat file and select an elastic runtime environment, store the flat file in the EFS file system and specify the following directory path:
	`/etc/infa/pod/<elastic runtime environment ID>/`
	To find the elastic runtime environment ID, navigate to the **Runtime Environments** page in Administrator and copy the elastic runtime environment ID from the URL.
	For example, in the URL `https://usw1.dmr-us.informaticacloud.com/cloudUI/products/administer/main/elastic-agent/KUBERNETES/0141GU25000000000002/overview`, the elastic runtime environment ID is 0141GU25000000000002.

Browse button	Use to locate and select the directory where flat files are stored.

Connection Property	Description
Date Format	Date format for date fields in the flat file. Select one of the following date formats: - MM/dd/yyyy HH:mm:ss - YYYY-MM-DD HH24:MI:SS.US
Code Page	The code page of the system that hosts the flat file. Select one of the following code pages: - MS Windows Latin 1. Select for ISO 8859-1 Western European data - UTF-8. Select for Unicode data - UTF-16 encoding of Unicode (Big Endian) - UTF-16 encoding of Unicode (Lower Endian) - Shift-JIS. Select for double-byte character data. - ISO 8859-15 Latin 9 (Western European) - ISO 8859-2 Eastern European - ISO 8859-3 Southeast European - ISO 8859-5 Cyrillic - ISO 8859-9 Latin 5 (Turkish) - IBM EBCDIC International Latin-1 - Japanese EUC (with \ <-> Yen mapping - IBM EBCDIC Japanese - IBM EBCDIC Japanese CP939 - PC Japanese SJIS-78 syntax (IBM-942) - PC Japanese SJIS-90 (IBM-943) - MS Windows Traditional Chinese, superset of Big 5 - Taiwan Big-5 (w/o euro update) - Chinese EUC - ISO 8859-8 Hebrew - PC Hebrew (old) - PC Hebrew (w/o euro update) - EBCDIC Hebrew (updated with new sheqel, control characters) - IBM EBCDIC US English IBM037 - UTF-32 encoding of Unicode (Lower Endian) - ISO 8859-1 Western European. - IBM EBCDIC French - ISO 8859-10 Latin 6 (Nordic) * - EBCDIC Finland, Sweden - MOS-DOS Thai, superset of TIS 620 - 7-bit ASCII - EBCDIC Finland, Sweden (w/euro update) - MS-DOS Windows Latin 2 (Central Europe) - Japanese EBCDIC-Kana Fujitsu - ISO 8859-7 Greek Characters in the file must be 2 bytes or less. In advanced mappings, flat file objects in cloud storage connections must use UTF-8 encoding. If the file contains supplementary characters with UTF-16 encoding, the task fails. **Note:** When you use a flat file connection with the Shift-JIS code page and a UTF data object, be sure to install fonts that fully support Unicode.
* Data preview uses a similar ISO 8859-4 Scandinavian/Baltic code page, but runtime processing uses ISO 8859-10 Latin 6 (Nordic), so data preview and runtime encoding won't match.	

Configuring a locale in Linux for flat file connections

On Linux, for synchronization or replication tasks that use a flat file connection, to support multibyte data you need to set the default locale to UTF-8.

1. To display the current locale, in a shell command line, enter `locale`.
2. To set the default locale to UTF-8, see the following examples:
   - For bash and related UNIX shells:

     ```
     export LC_ALL=en_US.UTF-8
     ```
   - For csh and related UNIX shells:

     ```
     setenv LC_ALL en_US.UTF-8
     ```
3. Restart the Secure Agent.

CHAPTER 2

Troubleshooting

Use the following sections to troubleshoot errors in Flat File Connector.

Troubleshooting a mapping task

Unable to read flat files that have multiple new line characters or carriage returns.

When flat files contain multiple new line characters or carriage returns, Data Integration is unable to read the files accurately.

To resolve this issue, set the MatchQuotesPastEndOfLine property in the mapping task:

1. On the **Runtime Options** page in the mapping task properties, navigate to the **Advanced Session Properties** section.
2. From the Session Property Name list, select **Custom Properties**, and set the Session Property Value to MatchQuotesPastEndOfLine=Yes.

Note: The MatchQuotesPastEndOfLine property works only with flat files that use ASCII-based code page. Ensure the file uses an ASCII-based codepage.

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